

iCloud+ plan page says the plan itself can be shared with up to five family members. That makes the larger tiers much more sensible for households than their sticker price initially suggests.

Step-by-step: iCloud storage before it bites you

1. Open Settings.
2. Tap your name.
3. Tap iCloud.
4. Review how much storage is being used and by what categories. Apple says you can check your iCloud storage usage in Settings or on icloud.com and manage or upgrade it there.

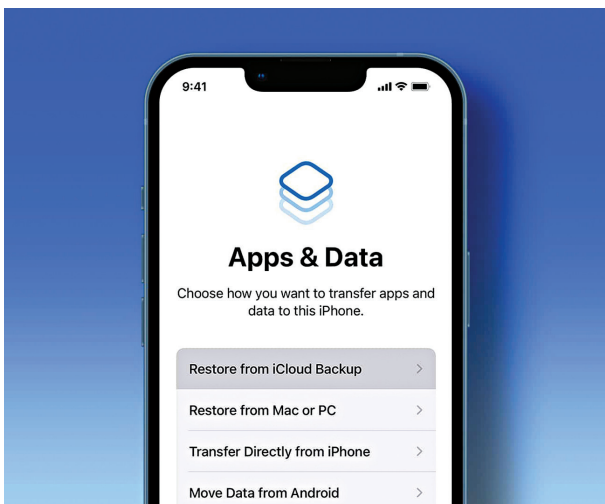
If storage is almost full, do not just buy more and move on. First check what is consuming it. Photos may be the obvious suspect, but old device backups, iCloud Drive clutter, and miscellaneous app data also pile up. Apple's storage-management page explicitly says iCloud space is used for backups, iCloud Photos, iCloud Drive and more. So diagnose first, subscribe second.

When a local computer backup makes sense

For many readers, iCloud Backup plus iCloud Photos will be enough for daily life. But local computer backups still deserve respect. They are useful if you want an additional copy outside the cloud, if your internet is unreliable, if you are about to do something risky, or if you simply like the comfort of having a backup that is not dependent on account storage, syncing behaviour or network mood swings. Apple's official guides show that you can back up and restore an iPhone with a Mac via Finder or with a Windows PC through the Apple Devices app.

Step-by-step: when to make a local backup too

1. Before selling, trading in or wiping an iPhone.
2. Before beta software or major iOS experiments.
3. Before long travel.



MOST COMMON IPHONE BACKUP MISTAKES

The first mistake is assuming iCloud Backup covers your photos even when iCloud Photos is turned on. Apple is explicit that photos are not duplicated into the backup in that scenario.

The second mistake is never checking whether automatic backup is actually enabled. People see "iCloud" in Settings and assume the rest is ceremonial. Apple's backup instructions specifically tell users to turn on Back Up This iPhone under iCloud Backup.

The third mistake is waiting until phone-upgrade day to think about backup. Apple's restore flow is wonderfully polished when everything is ready.

The fourth mistake is treating local backups as prehistoric. They are not. Apple still documents backing up and restoring through a Mac or through the Apple Devices app on Windows.

4. If your iCloud storage is tight and you need another safety layer.
5. If you want a second restore path beyond the cloud. Apple still supports local backup and restore on both Mac and Windows. This is not anti-cloud thinking. It is just backup maturity.

How to prepare for a new iPhone properly

The best time to care about iPhone backup is the day before you need it, not the day you are already staring at a new device and hoping your old phone has been more responsible than you have. Apple says that to restore from an iCloud backup, you should turn on the device, follow the setup steps until you reach Transfer Your Apps & Data, choose From iCloud Backup, then sign in. Apple also notes that if the device has already been set up, you need to erase it before using these restore steps.

Step-by-step: the night before replacing your iPhone

1. Check iCloud storage and make sure you are not full.
2. Confirm iCloud Backup is turned on.
3. Run a manual backup.
4. Make sure iCloud Photos has finished syncing recent photos and videos if you use it.
5. Keep the phone on Wi-Fi and power overnight. Apple says iCloud Backup works automatically under those conditions when the screen is locked.

That is the kind of boring preparation that turns a stressful migration into a routine one.